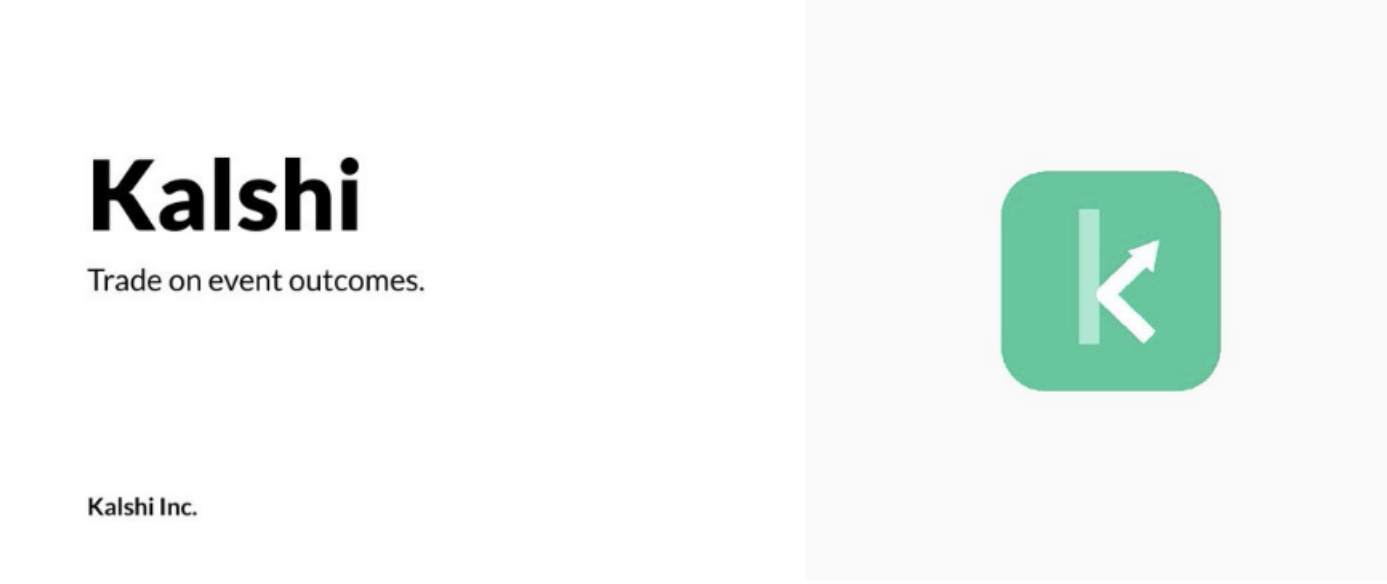
Alfred Lin
@Alfred_Lin



The Kalshi Series A Deck

103 229 1.7K 640K

Kalshi just announced their Series G, raising $1B at a $40B valuation. Tarek's post is worth reading, and shares more of the personal story behind the motivation for Kalshi and how his upbringing influenced where they are today.

@Kalshi may look obvious from a 2026 vantage point. It was not obvious in 2018, when @mansourtarek_ and @luanalopeslara founded the company, or in 2020, when we first partnered with them. We almost missed the opportunity entirely due to a miscommunication, but that's a story for another day.

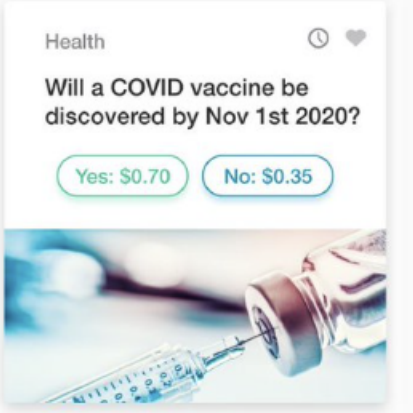
Many wonder what generational businesses look like when they first get started. Tarek and Luana were kind enough to let us share the entire Series A deck they used to pitch Sequoia, to inspire other founders who come after them.

The full deck is below, but a few highlights:

> Kalshi has been regulatory-first from the start. Trading on event outcomes seems obvious now but was still a non-obvious new asset class at the time.

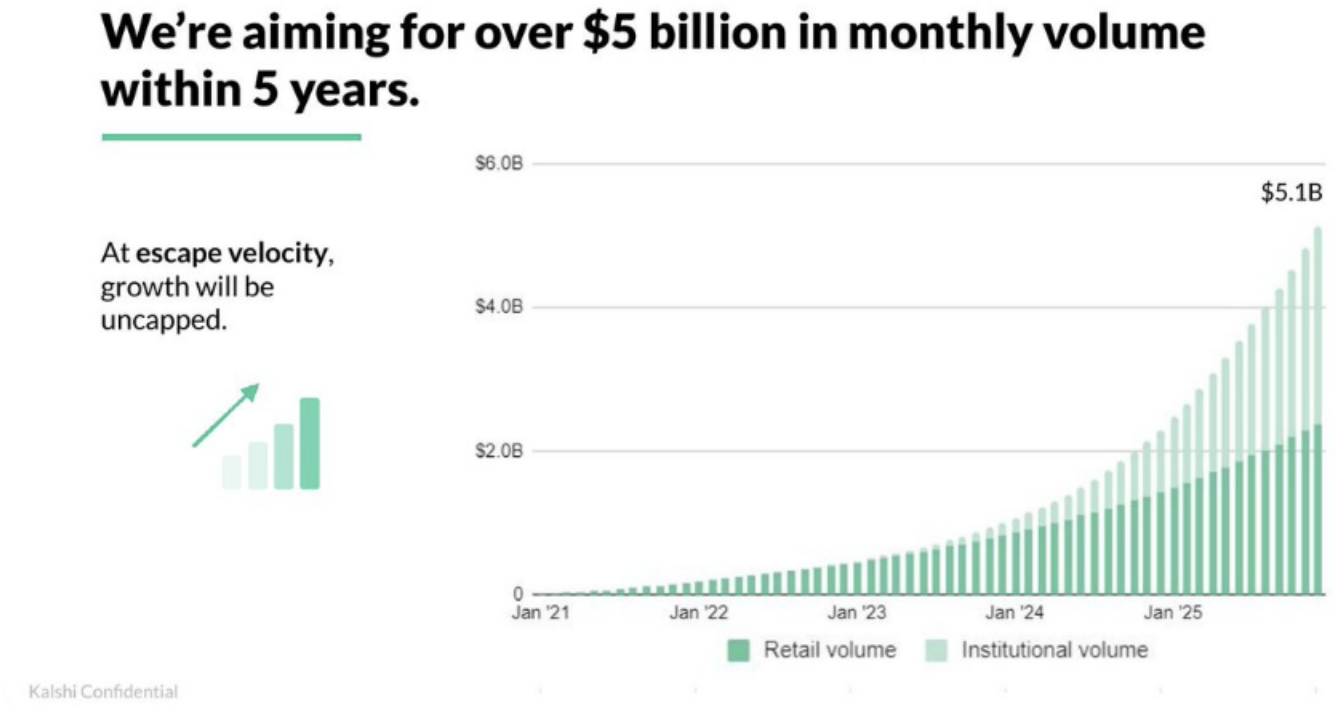
Imagine trading directly on event outcomes.

We have developed a new asset class, "event contracts," and will be the **first CFTC-regulated marketplace** where you can trade on the outcome of future events.



Kalshi Confidential

> Hockey stick charts are a trope, and few companies ever achieve them. Kalshi actually did achieve and exceed their projection on this timeline, even if the actual curve was MUCH choppier than planned. (Tarek has shared it felt like nothing was working for five years, before everything clicked.)



> You don’t need a flashy headshot to raise capital. Just ask Tarek:

Exec Team



Tarek Mansour
CEO
Ex MIT, Citadel, Goldman Sachs, Palantir



Luana Lopes Lara
COO
Ex MIT, Citadel, Bridgewater, AB InBeV

8 years in, it’s still Day 1 at Kalshi. We’re honored to continue partnering with them and co-lead their Series G. Hopefully seeing how they looked in the early days helps inspire the next generation of founders. Remember, everyone that’s extraordinary was once ordinary. Your predictable hockey-stick growth chart and finance intern headshot could be the start of the next legendary company.

Kalshi

Trade on event outcomes.



Kalshi Inc.

Kalshi Confidential

Imagine trading directly on event outcomes.

We have developed a new asset class, “event contracts,” and will be the **first CFTC-regulated marketplace** where you can trade on the outcome of future events.



Kalshi Confidential

Event contracts are the natural next step for financial markets.



A century ago: Supreme Court approved **grain futures**

Decades later: broader **commodity futures**

Turn of the millenium: **interest rate swaps**

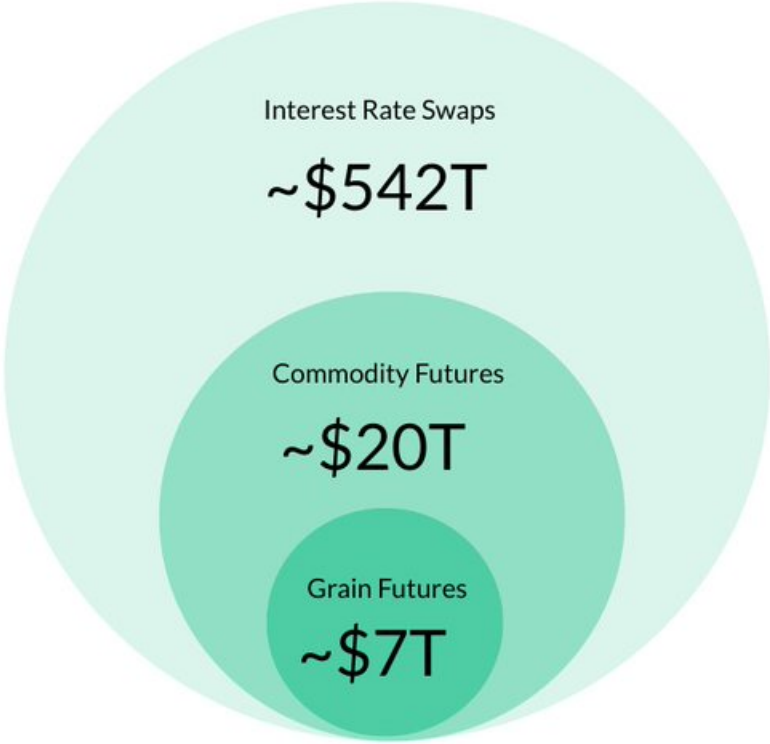
Next month: event contracts

Kalshi Confidential

Each past step unlocked trillions.

Exchanges that took advantage of these markets became essential to the economy:

CME	$5.0T - $24T*
ICE	$2.2T - $11.2T
CBOE	$1.9T - $9.5T



* Estimated yearly notional value traded.

Kalshi Confidential

Kalshi is on the verge of unlocking event trading.

We created a **proprietary & exclusionary** contract-vetting framework with the CFTC, which gives us access to a vast contract space.

Market Categories:

- Economics and financials
- International affairs and geopolitics
- Weather and climate
- Culture and media
- Science, technology and health

Kalshi Confidential

The road to get here wasn't easy.

We fought a **2-year long** regulatory battle and succeeded where many have failed.

- **February - December 2019:** Strategic engagement with the CFTC
- **July 2019:** Clearinghouse negotiations start
- **October 2019:** Kalshi policy memorandum on event contracts
- **December 2019:** Kalshi DCM application submitted and deemed materially complete
- **May 2020:** Kalshi technology demo to CFTC
- **May 2020:** Clearing agreement signed with LedgerX (DCO)
- **June 2020:** CFTC sign off on Kalshi systems and operations
- **September 2020:** Order of amendment allowing LedgerX to clear Kalshi contracts
- **October 2020:** Division of Market Oversight submits memorandum recommending Kalshi
- **November 2020:** Designation (anticipated)

Kalshi Confidential

This is a new market, and it's ours.

Barriers to competition start strong, and get stronger with time.

A required cost to play.

The process for designation takes 1-2 years on average.

+

Clearinghouse.

The only clearinghouse with the setup for event contracts is our partner.

• • •

Liquidity Effects.

Once we build liquidity, we're impossible to dethrone.

Kalshi Confidential

We will serve the market participants that drive liquidity.

Direct Retail
Traders can trade directly on the exchange

Brokers
Traders can submit trades through a broker



Market Makers
Firms post buy/sell spreads and are held to a minimum volume to supply liquidity

Kalshi Market Maker
Kalshi affiliate that seeds liquidity on the exchange

Kalshi Confidential

Liquidity begets liquidity: we'll build critical mass and become a full-fledged financial market.

01

Retail & Liquidity Providers

Start with bottled up demand in the exploding retail investing market

02

Institutional Traders

Attract institutional traders looking to more precisely invest in or hedge risk against events in their portfolios

03

Natural Hedgers

Attract individuals, businesses, and institutions looking to hedge event risk they face in their day-to-day

Kalshi Confidential

We have a multi-pronged approach to reaching the latent demand.

PR & Thought Leaders

Crafted PR strategy for financial/mainstream outlets

Thought leaders/influencers to build credibility

Earned media through market forecasts

Event Driven Marketing

Contract-specific ads matched to news articles

Kalshi Debates for contract launches

Contract-specific ads matched to questions on forums (Quora, Reddit)

Platform Marketing

Out of home campaigns

Social media user targeting

Ads on podcasts with large trader audiences

Incentivized referral program

Community ambassador programs

Partnerships

Broker partnerships

Affiliate relationships with news publishers

Contract data licensing agreements

Financial advisor relationships

Kalshi Confidential

Our content-driven flywheel will drive trader acquisition and activity.

Farm new event contracts
by gauging public sentiment from data sources and trader suggestions.

Score and launch contracts
with proprietary framework to ensure compliance & high trader demand.



Retain traders and expand volume
through contract recommendation system and notifications.

Convert new traders
through targeted placements matching news events to the corresponding event contracts.

Kalshi Confidential

Kalshi has already built the equivalent of 4 companies, from scratch.

Financial Exchange

Distributed **cloud exchange infrastructure**

State-of-the-art **matching and trade execution engine** for event contracts

Integration with a **CFTC regulated clearinghouse (DCO)** for custody and settlement

DTC Platform

Direct Exchange Access via a **web interface** and **mobile app**

Direct Exchange Access via **API.**

Market operations and systematic contract farming

Integrated **education hub** for event contracts and trading strategies

Trade Surveillance

Proprietary **trade surveillance systems** (KTSS) to detect market abuses

Self-governing compliance stack

Prop Trading

Affiliate market maker for seeding liquidity

Automated pricing models and algorithms for our markets

Kalshi Confidential

Kalshi has the exec team to get it done.

Exec Team



Tarek Mansour
CEO
Ex MIT, Citadel, Goldman Sachs, Palantir



Luana Lopes Lara
COO
Ex MIT, Citadel, Bridgewater, AB InBeV

[redacted]

Exchange Directors

[redacted]

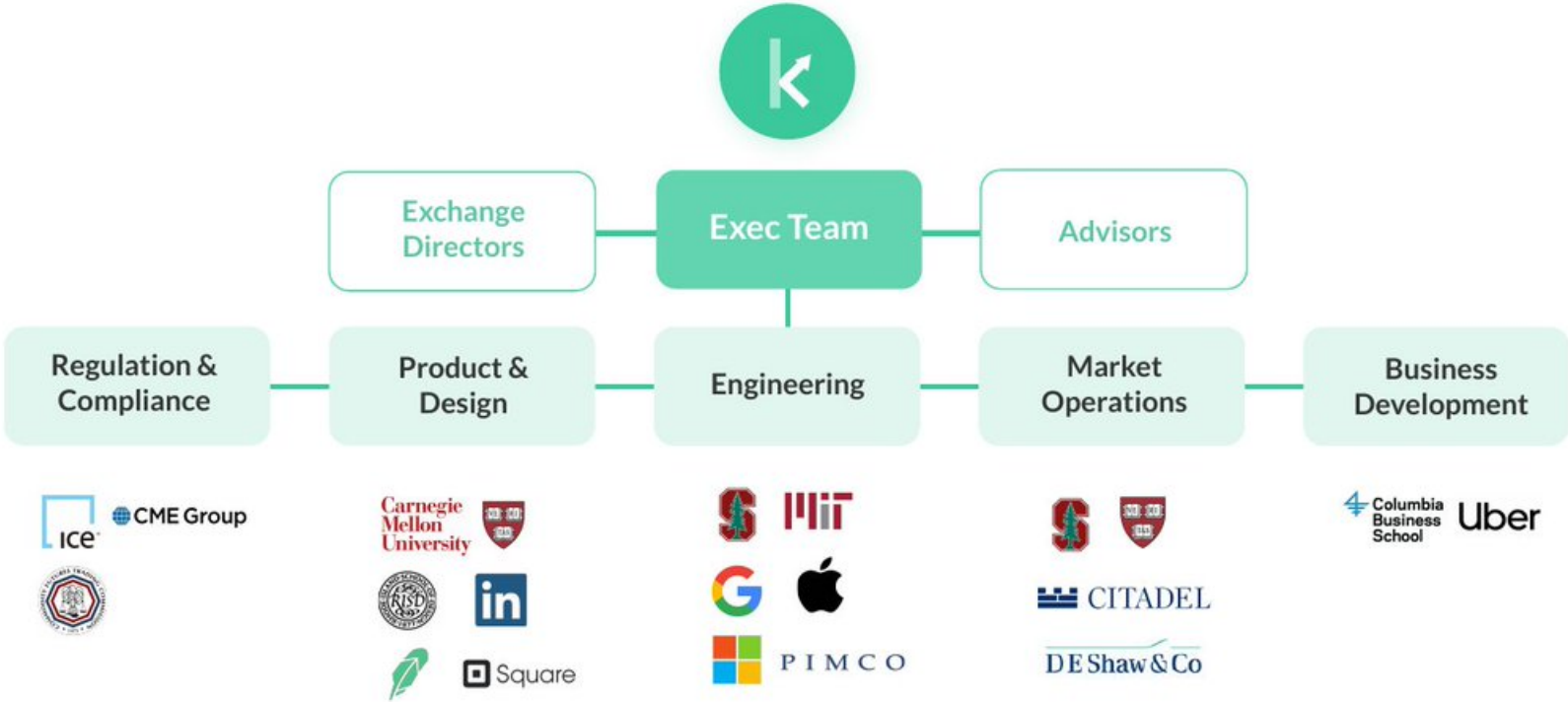
Regulatory Strategy

[redacted]

Advisors

[redacted]

Kalshi is already a 20-person team.

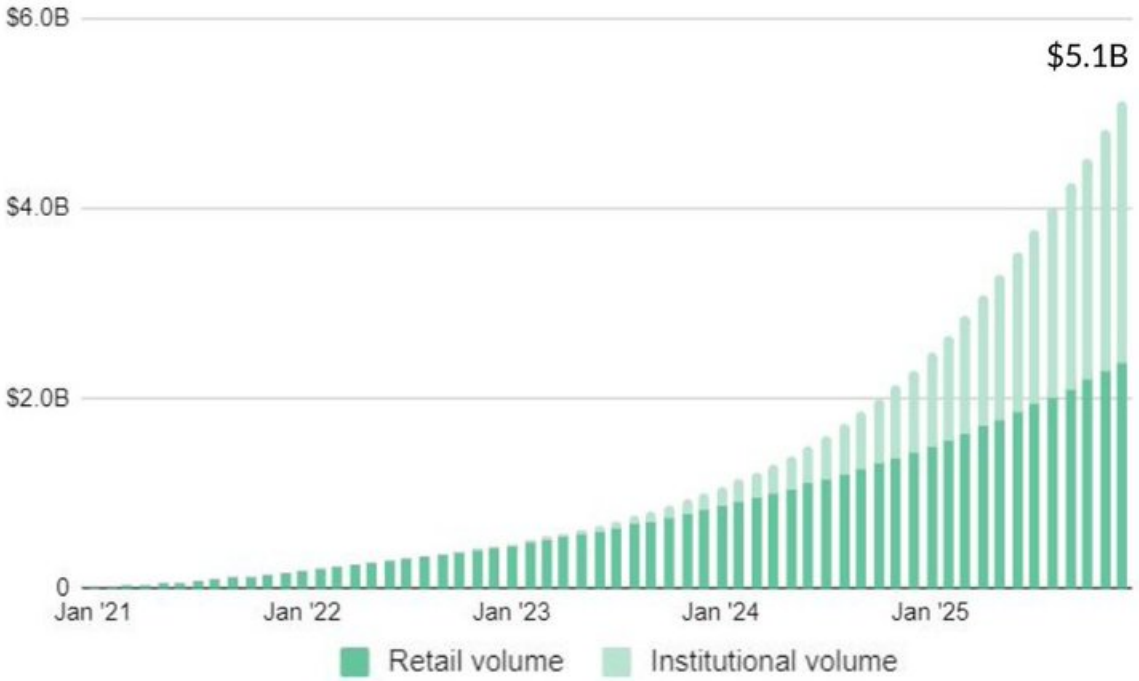


Kalshi Confidential

We’re aiming for over $5 billion in monthly volume within 5 years.

At **escape velocity**, growth will be uncapped.





Kalshi Confidential

We're aiming for over $350 million annualized revenue within 5 years.

Immediate

Trading Fees

0 - 2.5% fee per trade based on the price of the contract

Longer Term

Data Selling

Sell market sentiment data



Kalshi Confidential

Event contracts will become core to the U.S. financial system.

Since 1900, every innovation in futures & derivatives created a multi-trillion-$ market.

In 2020, the world is more connected and more exposed to events than ever, and is becoming more volatile each year.

Imagine a world...



where all event risks can be hedged.



where all opinions can be capitalized on.



where every person and organization can shield themselves from the world's volatility.

Kalshi Confidential

Q&A.

Kalshi Confidential